

TIME VOCABULARY - 1

Q1



Directions for questions 1 to 3: Each question has a pair of capitalized words followed by four pairs of words. Choose the pair of words that best expresses a relationship similar to that expressed by the capitalized pair.

APOCRYPHAL : MYTHICAL

- ☐ a) Anodyne : Imaginative
- ☐ b) Apathetic : Sluggish
- ☐ c) Pedagogical : Pedantic

☐ d) Vitriolic : Vituperative (Correct Answer - ✓)

Solution:

'Apocryphal' and 'mythical' are synonyms. Similarly, vitriolic (caustic) and vituperative are synonyms. Something that is 'anodyne' is dull and uninteresting. 'Pedagogical' means related to the methods and theory of teaching and 'pedantic' means too concerned with trivial details. 'Apathetic' is lack of interest but 'sluggish' is lack of effort.
Choice (D)

Directions for questions 1 to 3: Each question has a pair of capitalized words followed by four pairs of words. Choose the pair of words that best expresses a relationship similar to that expressed by the capitalized pair.

CARDINAL : PIVOTAL

- ☐ a) Ornate : Oracular
- ☐ b) Doctrinaire : Didactic
- ☐ c) Parochial : Bohemian

☐ d) Diffident : Reticent (Correct Answer - ✓)

Solution:

'Cardinal' and 'pivotal' are synonyms as are 'diffident' and 'reticent'. The rest are unrelated. Something that is 'ornate' is decorated with complicated patterns. 'Oracular' means 'prophetic'. 'Doctrinaire' which means dogmatic does not gel with 'didactic' which means instructional. 'Parochial' means narrow-minded and 'bohemian' means unconventional and are both unrelated. 'Choice (D)

Directions for questions 1 to 3: Each question has a pair of capitalized words followed by four pairs of words. Choose the pair of words that best expresses a relationship similar to that expressed by the capitalized pair.

MURDER : CROWS

☐ a) Down : Hares (Correct Answer - ✓)

☐ b) Swarm : Gnats

☐ c) Herd : Colts

☐ d) Siege : Hippopotami

Solution:

'Murder' is the collective noun for crows. 'Down' is the collective noun for 'hares'. The rest are mismatched. For 'gnats' the collective noun is 'cloud'. For 'colts' it is 'rag'. We say a 'bloat' of hippopotami, a 'swarm' of 'bees', a 'siege' of 'herons' and a 'flight' of 'doves'. Choice (A)

Directions for questions 4 to 7: There are two blanks in each of the following sentences. From the pairs of words given below each sentence, choose the pair that fills the blanks most appropriately.

In his weekly homily, the ____ cautioned us against treating anything in creation as ____, since every creation of God has a definite purpose.

☐ a) progenitor . . . congenial

☐ b) nestor . . . stygian

☐ c) inductor . . . prolixity

☐ d) lector . . . jetsam (Correct Answer - ✓)

Solution:

'Lector' refers to a reader in a church service or a lecturer in a foreign university who gives instruction in his native language. 'Jetsam' means discarded material, in other words, 'worthless things'. 'Nestor' refers to a wise old man, but 'stygian' refers to 'darkness'. So (B) is not a meaningful choice. 'Progenitor' means ancestor but 'congenial' means 'pleasant' or 'compatible', which makes it a wrong choice.

Choice (D)

Directions for questions 4 to 7: There are two blanks in each of the following sentences. From the pairs of words given below each sentence, choose the pair that fills the blanks most appropriately.

She has a ____ nature, but her job requires her to be ____.

☒ a) naive . . . insouciant (Your answer - ✕)

☐ b) cadaverous . . . judicious

☐ c) docile . . . doctrinaire (Correct Answer - ✓)

☐ d) gregarious . . . prescient

Solution:

The word 'but' clearly indicates that the blanks are to be filled with two contrasting words. She is docile or tractable, but her job requires her to be rigid. 'Doctrinaire' means to be 'dogmatic'. 'Naïve' means marked by unaffected simplicity. 'Insouciant' means light-hearted unconcern or nonchalance. 'Cadaverous' means of or relating to a corpse. 'Judicious' means having, exercising, or characterized by, sound judgment. 'Gregarious' means of or relating to social groups. 'Prescient' means knowing correctly what will happen in future.

Choice (C)

Directions for questions 4 to 7: There are two blanks in each of the following sentences. From the pairs of words given below each sentence, choose the pair that fills the blanks most appropriately.

While there are hundreds of voluntary ____ and testing centres for AIDS in the country, people at risk shrink from going there as apprehensions of ____ deter them.

☒ a) counselling . . . stigmatisation (Your answer - ✓)

☐ b) treatment . . . death

☐ c) charitable . . . adulteration

☐ d) concerned . . . victimization

Directions for questions 4 to 7: There are two blanks in each of the following sentences. From the pairs of words given below each sentence, choose the pair that fills the blanks most appropriately.

Many people are ____ by Spinoza because his writing style lends itself to so many ____ and yields new riches at every reading.

☐ a) inspired . . . associations

☐ b) afflicted . . . explanations

☐ c) impacted . . . analyses

☒ d) influenced . . . interpretations (Your answer - ✓)

Directions for questions 8 and 9: In each question, a word with its contextual usage is provided. Pick the word from among the alternatives that is the most appropriate substitute for the question word in the given context and mark the letter corresponding with it as your answer.

ECLECTIC : During his years as a literary editor he had tried to make the content of the magazine as eclectic as possible by commissioning articles from writers of different ages.

- ☐ a) exiguous
- ☐ b) slender
- ☐ c) circumscribed

☒ d) wide-ranging (Your answer - ✓)

Directions for questions 8 and 9: In each question, a word with its contextual usage is provided. Pick the word from among the alternatives that is the most appropriate substitute for the question word in the given context and mark the letter corresponding with it as your answer.

CHARLATAN : Like so many other orators, William was also something of a charlatan; from his schooldays he powered the ability to speak fluently on ideas he had only partially digested, each of his theories was an act of appropriation.

☐ a) quack

☒ b) errant (Your answer - ✗)

☐ c) swindler (Correct Answer - ✓)

☐ d) paradigm

Solution:

'Charlatan' is a person falsely claiming a special knowledge or skill. 'Quack' means the same but it qualifies a fake doctor. Given the context of the sentence, 'swindler' (which means fraudster or trickster) will be the correct choice. Choice (C)

Directions for questions 10 and 11: Each question has four items. Three of them are related or belong to one group and the fourth does not. Select as your answer that item which does not belong to the group.

☐ a) potent

☒ b) fecund (Your answer - ✖)

☐ c) effeminate (Correct Answer - ✔)

☐ d) prolific

Solution:

Potent, fecund and prolific are all related to fertility, and the ability to produce. Effeminate alone is unconnected as it means characteristics of a woman and is used derogatorily.
Choice (C)

Directions for questions 10 and 11: Each question has four items. Three of them are related or belong to one group and the fourth does not. Select as your answer that item which does not belong to the group.

☒ a) virus (Your answer - ✔)

☐ b) plague

☐ c) contagion

☐ d) epidemic

Directions for questions 12 to 14: In the following passages there are blanks, each of which has been numbered. These numbers are printed below the passage and against each, four words are suggested, one of which fits the blank appropriately. Find out the appropriate word in each case and mark the letter corresponding with it as your answer.

Immigration is changing Britain, and people find change **(12)**. Governments need to be careful. That means, for instance, letting immigrants stay where there are lots of other immigrants, and where they are therefore, **(13)**. Some of the loudest recent rows have been over setting up camps for asylum seekers in bits of the (still very white) countryside. And the government needs to address the question of **(14)** immigrants for infectious diseases.

☐ a) sinister

☒ b) frightening (Your answer - ✓)

☐ c) harrowing

☐ d) hideous

Directions for questions 12 to 14: In the following passages there are blanks, each of which has been numbered. These numbers are printed below the passage and against each, four words are suggested, one of which fits the blank appropriately. Find out the appropriate word in each case and mark the letter corresponding with it as your answer.

Immigration is changing Britain, and people find change **(12)**. Governments need to be careful. That means, for instance, letting immigrants stay where there are lots of other immigrants, and where they are therefore, **(13)**. Some of the loudest recent rows have been over setting up camps for asylum seekers in bits of the (still very white) countryside. And the government needs to address the question of **(14)** immigrants for infectious diseases.

☒ a) camouflaged (Your answer - ✗)

☐ b) insignificant

☐ c) ostentatious

☐ d) inconspicuous (Correct Answer - ✓)

Solution:

Allowing the new immigrants to stay where other immigrants are there will make them inconspicuous (not clearly visible or not attracting attention). They are not camouflaged (disguised) or insignificant (too small or unimportant) or ostentatious (showy).
Choice (D)

Directions for questions 12 to 14: In the following passages there are blanks, each of which has been numbered. These numbers are printed below the passage and against each, four words are suggested, one of which fits the blank appropriately. Find out the appropriate word in each case and mark the letter corresponding with it as your answer.

Immigration is changing Britain, and people find change **(12)**. Governments need to be careful. That means, for instance, letting immigrants stay where there are lots of other immigrants, and where they are therefore, **(13)**. Some of the loudest recent rows have been over setting up camps for asylum seekers in bits of the (still very white) countryside. And the government needs to address the question of **(14)** immigrants for infectious diseases.

☒ a) screening (Your answer - ✓)

☐ b) sheltering

☐ c) safeguarding

☐ d) masking

Directions for question 15: For the word given on the top of the table, match the dictionary definitions given in the left hand columns (a, b, c, d) with their corresponding usage given in the right hand column (e, f, g, h). Out of the four choices given in the boxes, identify the one that has all definitions and usages correctly matched.

INVENTION

a. the ability to develop new and interesting ideas	e. The internet has proved to be a remarkable invention.
b. the act of inventing something	f. The invention of the printing press catalysed the Renaissance.
c. a story that is untrue	g. The precocious child was full of invention.
d. a thing or idea that has been created	h. His explanation for his absence was a complete invention.

☐

a)

a	g
b	f
c	h
d	e

(Correct Answer - ✓)

☐

b)

a	h
b	e
c	g
d	f

☐

c)

a	g
b	f
c	e
d	h